

QA Evidence — search + auth fixes verified on nezha (2026-06-16)

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Real end-to-end verification on the live distributed-boot production stack (nezha.local, podman). Anti-bluff §11.4 / §11.4.107 / §11.4.69 — assertions are on user-observable outcomes (result counts, real titles, per-tracker status), NOT status codes.

1. Private-tracker cookie auth (operator-supplied browser cookies)

Operator complaint: rutracker/nnmclub never authenticated. Fix: NNMCLUB_COOKIES (existing) + the new RUTRACKER_COOKIES injection (commit 2fc29fc), cookies extracted from the operator’s browser export by scripts/extract-tracker-cookies.sh (only the tracker’s own-domain cookies, §11.4.10).

Tracker	query	status	total	sample real title
rutracker	the matrix	completed	50	“Матрица / The Matrix (Энди/Ларри Вачовски)”
nnmclub	the matrix	completed	50	“The Matrix OST (1999)”, “Matrix Resurrections (2021)”

Both were auth-failing every query before (rutracker no_cookie/CAPTCHA, nnmclub Cloudflare Turnstile). Container env confirmed carrying both cookie vars (phpbb2mysql_4_sid=1, bb_session=1).

2. Multi-word query URL-encoding crash (the “search broken / crashing a lot”)

Root cause (FACT): ~17 nova3 plugins interpolated the RAW query into a request URL; a literal space crashed urllib (URL can't contain control characters). Single-word worked, multi-word silently lost the plugin. Fix: per-plugin URL-encoding (commits dbd3858 7 maintained + da7d709 10 adopted/limetorrents) + honesty classifier plugin_bad_query_encoding (33d90f2).

Scoped multi-word search (the `matrix`) of the 10 adopted plugins — `search_id 6a3da978-d2d4-4b2d-bb6b-a1dfb5d8c43f`, **total=592**:

plugin	status	results
glotorrents	success	173
torrentdownload	success	249
torrentproject	success	68
snowfl	success	40
limetorrents	success	36
torrentscsv	success	25
rockbox	success	1
linuxtracker	empty	0 (no error — no match for this query)
pirateiro	empty	0 (no error)
yourbittorrent	error	0 — <code>deadline_timeout</code> (slow, NOT an encoding crash)

STILL `bad_query_encoding/crashed`: NONE — the encoding-crash storm is eliminated. (Earlier maintained-7 run: `bitsearch 60`, `torrentgalaxy 150`, `nyaa 5`.) Full-fleet the `matrix` previously returned 1135–1705 results.

3. `auth/status` now reflects cookies (commit `9c2f8dc`)

`/auth/status` previously showed red/unauthenticated chips for `rutracker/nnmclub` despite working searches (it only read `_tracker_sessions`, populated after a search). Now reflects the `*_COOKIES` env so the dashboard shows them green.

4. Deploy pipeline fully fixed + re-verified via the pipeline (not manual cp)

`scripts/deploy-remote.sh` had 4 silent-failure bugs that kept fixes from landing on the remote (§11.4.108): inline-YAML-comment in the parsed path (`d5b58cb`), `rsync` abort on container-owned `config/` under `set -e` (`9e059d3`), `py_compile` writing `__pycache__` to a container-owned dir → false “Syntax: Invalid” → exit 1 (`42cdb02`), and `install-plugin` targeting only `qbittorrent` not the `qbittorrent-proxy` container that runs the engine subprocess (`e6b9f8f`). After the fixes the pipeline completes `[1/5]→[5/5]` cleanly (“All plugins installed and valid!”, 0 “Syntax: Invalid”).

Re-run AFTER a clean pipeline deploy (engines installed by the pipeline, NOT a manual cp) — scoped multi-word the `matrix`, **total=573**, `glotorrents 173`, `torrentdownload 249`, `torrentproject 60`, `snowfl 40`, `limetorrents 25`, `torrentscsv 25`, `rockbox 1` (success); `linuxtracker/pirateiro` empty-no-error; `yourbittorrent` `deadline_timeout` (slow, not a crash). **STILL `bad_query_encoding/crashed`: NONE**. Engine fix confirmed present in `qbittorrent-proxy` (`glotorrents` fix marker count 1) — installed by the pipeline.

5. Regression baseline

Full unit suite at HEAD e6b9f8f: **4277 passed, 0 failed** (9m51s) — up from 4216 pre-session (all new tests for the search/cookie/auth fixes pass, zero regression).

6. Definitive end-to-end proof — full-fleet multi-word search

Full-fleet the matrix on nezha (search_id 4bd0dd12, completed):

- **total = 2600 results**, 29 trackers reported, **23 contributing**
- **encoding-crashed: NONE**
- **all four private trackers authenticate**: rutracker 50, nnmclub 50, kinozal 50, iptorrents 49 — every one success

This is the complete confirmation that search works for end users: the same multi-word query the pre-session build crashed ~17 plugins on now returns 2600 results with every tracker healthy and all private-tracker auth working.

7. UTF-8 / Cyrillic query fix — proven live (P0 from the discovery sweep)

The §11.4.118 discovery sweep found 14 plugins crashed on a Cyrillic query ('ascii' codec can't encode). Fix ae387b2 (per-plugin quote/quote_plus UTF-8-safe encoding). Re-deployed via the pipeline; live nezha Cyrillic search Война и мир (14 fixed plugins) — **total = 290 results, CRASHED/encoding-err: NONE**:

plugin	status	results
torrentgalaxy	success	198
bitsearch	success	80
torrentscsv	success	11
torrentdownload	success	1
glotorrents/linuxtracker/ nyaa/pirateiro/rockbox/ snowfl/torrentproject	empty	0 (no error — handled, no match)
tokyotoshokan/torlock/ yourbittorrent	deadline_timeout	0 (slow upstream, NOT a crash)

Before the fix every one of the 14 crashed with `ascii` codec; now zero crashes and real Cyrillic results — the core use case for a Russian-tracker fleet. Unit: 97 passed (43 unicode + 54 multiword), §1.1 mutation proven.

Captured 2026-06-16 against nezha.local; unit coverage: multiword tests (16 plugins capture + snowfl focused + well-behaved no-regression) + unicode/Cyrillic tests (14 plugins) + rutracker-cookie + auth-status cookie-reflection tests, all with §1.1 negation proofs.